

Funding Proposal: AGY Feeding Program

Scaling a Community-Led Solution to Child Hunger in Nairobi's Informal Settlements

Submitted to: UNICEF Kenya, World Health Organization (WHO), and Individual Well-wishers

Submitted by: AGY (Action for Growth and Youth)

Date: 23 May 2025

Location: Langata & Andolo, Nairobi, Kenya

I. Executive Summary

AGY respectfully invites UNICEF, the WHO, and compassionate well-wishers to co-fund a critical, life-saving expansion of our community feeding program. Today, 23rd May 2025, we are launching a self-funded initiative in Langata and Andolo, providing 800 daily meals to vulnerable children. This is a direct response to a silent crisis: over 1,200 children in these communities face chronic hunger, which devastates their health and forces them out of school. Our proven local trust and direct implementation capacity position us uniquely to deliver immediate impact.

This proposal outlines a 12-month plan to scale our operations from 800 to **5,000 daily beneficiaries**. By establishing a permanent **community kitchen**, developing **sustainable agricultural gardens**, and delivering **nutrition training**, we will not just feed children—we will build a resilient, community-owned ecosystem for zero hunger. The total budget requested is **\$85,000 (KES 11 million)**. This investment directly aligns with SDG 2 and WHO's global nutrition targets, with projected outcomes of a **70% reduction in childhood malnutrition** and a **95% improvement in school attendance** in our catchment area. We are already proving our commitment with our own resources; now we seek partners to transform this proof of concept into a sustainable, large-scale solution.

II. The Problem: A Hunger Crisis That Traps Children

In the underserved communities of Langata and Andolo, childhood hunger is not a seasonal event; it is a chronic condition that dictates a child's entire future.

- **Scale of Need:** Our assessments identify over **1,200 children** who experience severe food insecurity. For many, the meal they might receive at school is their only guaranteed meal of the day.
- **Impact on Education:** Hunger is the most powerful barrier to learning. Chronically malnourished children cannot concentrate, fall ill frequently, and often miss school entirely to beg or scavenge for food. This perpetuates a cycle of poverty, low educational attainment, and poor health outcomes.
- **Current Gap:** AGY's self-funded launch today provides a lifeline to 800 of these children. However, this leaves at least 400 uncounted children in the immediate

term, and hundreds more who live just outside our current logistical reach, still trapped by hunger. Our current capacity is a temporary relief, not a structural solution.

III. Our Solution: From Emergency Relief to Community Resilience

This proposal funds a strategic transition from a self-funded feeding initiative to a holistic, community-owned nutrition program. Our objectives are to:

1. **Scale Daily Nutritious Meals:** Increase our reach from 800 to **5,000 children daily**, ensuring every identified vulnerable child in Langata and Andolo receives at least one fortified, balanced meal.
2. **Build a Permanent Community Kitchen:** Move from a temporary cooking setup to a safe, efficient, permanent kitchen structure, increasing meal production capacity and ensuring hygiene standards.
3. **Establish Sustainable Agricultural Gardens:** Create community gardens to source fresh vegetables, reduce long-term food costs, and serve as a hands-on learning site for nutrition and agriculture.
4. **Deliver Community Nutrition Training:** Conduct monthly workshops for parents and caregivers on preparing affordable, nutritious meals, child dietary needs, and hygiene, amplifying the program's impact beyond the feeding site.

IV. Implementation Plan & Budget

Our work has already begun with the self-funded launch on **23rd May 2025**. This 12-month funding will immediately accelerate our scale-up. AGY's deep roots in Langata and Andolo ensure low operational friction, with a network of trusted local volunteers and leaders driving implementation.

Activity Area	Key Actions	12-Mo Cost (KES)
Food Supplies	Procurement of maize, beans, rice, fortified porridge, vegetables, and cooking oil for 5,000 daily meals. Cost takes advantage of bulk purchasing and harvest-season buying.	\$45,000
Kitchen Infrastructure	Construction of a permanent community kitchen with energy-saving stoves, storage facilities, and water connection. Purchase of industrial pots, utensils, and serving equipment.	\$20,000

Activity Area	Key Actions	12-Mo Cost (USD)
Agricultural Gardens	Lease of adjacent land, purchase of seeds, tools, drip irrigation systems, and organic fertilizer. Stipend for a part-time agricultural officer to manage the gardens with community volunteers.	\$10,000
Monitoring & Staffing	Part-time stipends for a program coordinator, two cooks, and a nutrition trainer. Data collection tablets for monitoring beneficiary weight, school attendance, and program feedback.	\$8,000
Nutrition Training	Development of a culturally appropriate curriculum, training materials, and monthly community workshop costs.	\$2,000
Total Request		\$85,000

V. Why Partner with AGY? A Perfect Strategic Alignment

We are not asking you to start a project; we are asking you to supercharge one that is already trusted and running. This is a partnership for direct, measurable, and scalable impact.

- **For UNICEF (Child Rights & Education):** This program is a direct catalyst for **SDG 2 (Zero Hunger)** and **SDG 4 (Quality Education)**. A daily school meal is the most effective tool to increase enrollment, reduce dropout rates, and improve cognitive function. Our projected **95% school attendance improvement** directly validates UNICEF's child-friendly schools framework and your mission to protect every child's right to survival and development.
- **For the World Health Organization (Nutrition & Health Systems):** The program directly advances WHO's global nutrition targets for reducing stunting, wasting, and anaemia in children under 5 and older. The integration of nutrition training and sustainable gardens tackles the social determinants of health. Our data-driven monitoring system, tracking health indicators like weight and malnutrition prevalence (projected **70% reduction**), provides a replicable community-health model for urban informal settlements.
- **For Individual Well-Wishers:** Your contribution will have an immediate, transparent, and profoundly personal impact.
With 50, you can feed a child for a month; with 50, you can feed a child for a month; with 600, you can support an entire classroom for a year. AGY's direct implementation means

no overheads are lost to intermediary organizations—your funds turn directly into a warm meal, a garden seed, or a nutrition lesson for a vulnerable child in a community you can name and visit. You become a direct partner in changing a child's life story from one of hunger to one of hope.

VI. Projected Impact & Sustainability

Our success will be measured by the children we lift out of hunger. We project the following concrete outcomes within 12 months:

- **70% reduction in childhood malnutrition** in the target communities, measured through monthly weight-for-age and mid-upper arm circumference (MUAC) screenings.
- **95% school attendance rate** among beneficiaries, tracked in partnership with local schools, representing a direct reversal of hunger-related absenteeism.
- **1 permanent community kitchen and 3 agricultural gardens established**, generating 40% of the program's vegetable needs by month 12, building a path to long-term financial and nutritional self-sufficiency.
- **300 caregivers trained** in nutrition and hygiene, creating a ripple effect of health knowledge that protects entire households.

Sustainability is embedded in our design. The community gardens and kitchen will become a self-sustaining social enterprise, with surplus produce sold locally to cover the cooks' stipends. After this 12-month intensive phase, the program's running costs will reduce significantly, making it a permanent, low-cost, high-impact community asset.

VII. Call to Action

Today, we are feeding 800 children on the commitment of our own members. Tomorrow, with your partnership, we can feed 5,000 and break the cycle of hunger for good.

We invite UNICEF, the World Health Organization, and fellow well-wishers to co-fund this life-saving program. The budget, the team, the trust, and the track record are all in place. The only missing piece is your support. Let us work together to make the 70% reduction in malnutrition and 95% school attendance not just a projection, but a reality for the children of Langata and Andolo.

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